

Three children can take sides in 6 ways, and 3 of those are one against one

Every possible split into two opposing sides, with anyone left over staying out of it.

These are possibilities, not arguments that happened — and the commonest case of all, nobody taking sides, is not among them.

 one side  the other side  staying out

One against one — the sibling pairs (3 of 6)



A vs B
C stays out



A vs C
B stays out



B vs C
A stays out

One against two (3)



A vs B+C
nobody left out



B vs A+C
nobody left out



C vs A+B
nobody left out